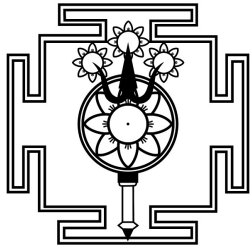
TANTRIC PRAYER

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TANTRIC PRAYER

Thirty-Six Prayers for the Inner Weather



Tantric Prayer — Thirty-Six Prayers for the Inner Weather.
First edition.

Texts drawn from the Śaiva corpus, with translations for this edition.

Set in Cormorant Garamond and Tiro Devanagari Sanskrit.

AUDIO COMPANION
SCAN TO LISTEN TO EVERY PRAYER

अपि लब्धभवद्भावः स्वात्मोल्लासमयं जगत् / पश्यन् भक्तिरसाभोगैर्
भवेयम् अवियोजितः

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 5.16

INTRODUCTION

Tantric Prayer is the companion to *Practical Prayers*. That book was for the moments of the day; this one is for the weather inside it. Same form — a prayer facing its explanation — but the sections are not places. They are the nine rasas, the classical table fixed by Abhinavagupta himself in the Abhinavabhāratī, where he added the ninth, śānta.

The claim is his, and it is old: an emotion is not an obstacle to practice — it is consciousness already tasting itself in that key. Fear, grief, rage and wonder are one wonder (camatkāra) in nine costumes. So this book never argues with a feeling. It gives it its Sanskrit name, its literal sense, its conventional term and its sthāyibhāva — and then says a verse at it. The prayer does not banish the emotion; it re-tastes it, which is what recognition feels like when it wears that emotion's face.

Every verse comes from our own Kashmir Śaiva corpus: thirty-two from Utpaladeva's *Śivastotrāvalī*, one each from Kṣemarāja's *Ghaṭakarpara*, Abhinavagupta's *Kramastotra* — in Swami Lakshmanjoo's own recitation list — and Abhinavagupta's *Gītārthasaṅgraha* — plus the Yajurvedic Aghora chant Swamiji opened every
Sangha with, keeping watch at the fear door. Translations are ours, checked line by line against the corpus witnesses; each guide links to its source. Theory quotations are short and attributed; their references are flagged for verification against print editions.

Where *Practical Prayers* gave you a verse for the sink and the desk, these give you one for the inside. Read the guide when you meet a prayer; after that, the prayer page alone is enough.

WHAT IS A RASA?

Every feeling you will ever have — fear, grief, rage, delight — is already a particular **camatkāra** of consciousness. Wonder is not one emotion among others; it is the primary characteristic of consciousness itself (Tantrāloka, ad 1/53), and perception itself is an act of wonder (TĀ 1260–68). "The mental fluctuations of anger and the like exist because they are one with the wonder that is the experience of consciousness" (TĀ 15254).

So the door is not something to build. Anxiety is consciousness in one of its flavours; grief is another. Abhinavagupta's most radical claim follows: **all rasas are essentially pleasurable — even the painful emotions**, and "the nature of suffering is, essentially, a particular kind of wonder" (TĀ 25585–94). Emotions only "lend variety to the enjoyment of this bliss."

This book does not argue you out of any feeling. It re-tastes them: the move from **felt-AT** to **savoured-AS** — what Sanskrit poetics calls objectification and sādhāraṇīkaraṇa — and the savour is recognition wearing that emotion's face.

THEORY: ABHINAVABHĀRATĪ & TANTRĀLOKA, VIA THE HOUSE RASA SESSIONS

THE NINE RASAS

The classical table of nine (Nāṭyaśāstra), fixed by Abhinavagupta in his Abhinavabhāratī — where he added the ninth, śānta. Each rasa carries its **sthāyibhāva**, the permanent emotion beneath it. Four prayers per rasa; each section's divider gives the literal sense, the conventional term, the sthāyin and the doctrine.

RASA & ITS LITERAL SENSE	CONVENTIONAL	THE DOOR	STHĀYIN
Śṛṅgāra amorous sentiment, love; the beauty that adorns	**the Erotic**	*love, longing*	*rati*
Hāsya laughable, comic; mockery — that which slays	**the Comic**	*mirth, laughter*	*hāsa*
Karuṇā compassion, mercy; the pitiable, what moves to pity	**the Pathetic**	*grief, compassion*	*śoka*
Raudra furious, stormy — the mood of Rudra	**the Furious**	*fury, rage*	*krodha*
Vīra heroic, manly valour; mighty effort	**the Heroic**	*valour, energy*	*utsāha*
Bhayānaka causing fear: terrible, dreadful	**the Horrible**	*fear, terror*	*bhaya*
Bībhatsa loathsome, revolting; that which excites disgust	**the Disgusting**	*disgust, loathing*	*jugupsā*
Adbhuta the un-become: astonishing, marvellous, unprecedented	**the Marvellous**	*wonder, awe*	*vismaya*
Śānta pacified, allayed, put to rest" — the ninth, added by Abhinavagupta	**the Peaceful**	*peace (his ninth)*	*śānti*

NĀṬYAŚĀSTRA · ABHINAVABHĀRATĪ · MONIER-WILLIAMS GLOSSES · THIRTY-SIX PRAYERS INSIDE

HOW TO USE A DOORWAY

1 — Name it. Say what the feeling actually is, plainly: fear, jealousy, boredom. Objectifying is the first half of sādhāraṇīkaraṇa — the feeling stops being you.

2 — Stay one breath. Do not fix, do not flee. The rasa is alaukika — beyond time and space — yet felt (sva-saṁvedana). Staying lets it be what it is: consciousness tasting itself in that key.

3 — Recognise. Ask: whose camatkāra is this? The answer is already the book's thesis — it is the one taste wearing the emotion. That flicker is recognition.

4 — Say the prayer. The verse is the re-tasting instrument. It does not banish the feeling; it converts felt-AT into savoured-AS. Read the guide once when you meet a prayer; after that, the prayer page alone is enough.

Sources: verses from our Kashmir Shaiva corpus (translation-work) — Abhinavagupta, Utpaladeva, Kṣemarāja, Vasugupta — each linked from its guide. Theory quotes are short and attributed; verify against print editions before study.

DECODING THE VERSES — THE AXIOMS (1 OF 2)

Rasa — a taste, not an emotion: consciousness's own flavour, savoured.

Why: Abhinavabhāratī — rasa is "the enjoyment of one's own consciousness as uniform bliss"; the feelings are the variety, the taste is the one. Hence all rasas pleasurable, even the painful ones.

Camatkāra — wonder: the signature of consciousness.

Why: Tantrāloka ad 1/53 — wonder distinguishes the conscious from the insentient; perception itself is "it appears to me," and that appearing is camatkāra. Emotions are particular camatkāras (TĀ 15254).

Sthāyibhāva — the permanent root beneath each rati, śoka, krodha, bhaya…

Why: emotions pass, roots remain; the nine roots are why nine doors are enough — every transient state is accounted for by one stable taste. (Nāṭyaśāstra / Abhinavabhāratī)

Alaukika — the taste beyond time and space, yet felt.

Why: Abhinavabhāratī's paradox — rasa is not an object (no empirical means reaches it) yet sva-saṁvedana: "because rasa is felt, therefore it exists." Resolution: it is subject-relish, not object-fact.

Sādhāraṇīkaraṇa — universalisation: one heart, many sharers.

Why: a single person's grief is not yet rasa — the private feeling must be lifted to the shareable; that lifting is exactly what converts suffering into taste. This is the book's central move.

Vimarśa — awareness bent back on itself: the feel of feeling.

Why: light with no surface shines nowhere; consciousness needs itself as its mirror — every emotion is vimarśa's particular curvature.

DECODING THE VERSES — THE AXIOMS (2 OF 2)

Spanda — the pulse: by whose opening and closing the world arises and dissolves.

Why: Spandakārikā 1.1 — the world blinks; emotions are blinks too — raised and lowered states of one pulse, which is why no feeling lasts and none needs to.

Bhāva — the feeling as it appears, before it is savoured (the raw presentation).

Why: raw → presented → tasted: the same event at three depths. Prayer works at the third — that is why the guides never argue with the raw layer.

Svātantrya — freedom: the feeling must be allowed to be what it is.

Why: if consciousness is freedom, a suppressed emotion contradicts its own ground; the doorway practice permits first, transforms second.

Pratyabhijñā — recognition wearing the emotion's face.

Why: bondage as real makes freedom impossible — yet the difference is felt; so bondage is misreading, and the savoured feeling is what corrects it. (the same axiom as the first book, in rasa's key)

Anupāya — the no-means: techniques are optional, tasting is not.

Why: Anuttarāṣṭikā 1 drops contemplation, japa and visualization — yet the rasa still arrives; the arrival was never caused by the doing.

Māyā — not the world's denial but its manufacture, seen from below.

Why: "the world, both real and unreal" (Mahopadeśaviṃśatikā 11) — real as his expression, unreal only from the underside. Emotions belong to the making, not the mistake.

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I

Śṛṅgāra

the Erotic — desire & longing

śṛṅgāra — "amorous sentiment, love; the beauty that adorns" (Monier-Williams)

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sthāyin: rati — the beloved becomes the light of consciousness;
separation is its fuel (Abhinavabhāratī)

The Un-Drunk One's Thirst

भवद्भक्त्यमृतास्वादाद् बोधस्य स्यात् परापि या / दशा सा मां प्रति स्वामिन् नासवस्येव शुक्तता

bhavadbhaktyamṛtāsvādād bodhasya syāt parāpi yā / daśā sā māṃ prati svāmin nāsavasyeva śuktatā

may the higher knowledge come from tasting the nectar of your devotion —
that state, lord, turn toward me,
keen as the not-yet-drunk one's thirst for the first drink.[1]

The Un-Drunk One's Thirst

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.11 · 1.11

Desire as holy thirst — rati aimed at God instead of at the world.

WHAT IS IT

The sthāyin rati is not to be removed but redirected. The verse names the exact texture: nāsavas-śuktatā, the eagerness of one who has NOT yet tasted — the pre-taste longing. Knowledge itself (bodha) comes by the sip; the prayer is therefore for the thirst to be aimed at him, and for the state to turn toward the speaker.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When longing is loud: say the verse and let the object of the longing become the taste of devotion rather than the thing you'd grab.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the thirst stops being lack and starts being flavour: you want him the way the moon wants the ocean, and the wanting itself tastes full.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

keep the ache — it is the rasa before it arrives; the thirst IS the practice.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.11

The Wine of Non-Difference

क्षणम् अपीह न तावकदासतां प्रति भवेयम् अहं किल भाजनम् / भवदभेदरसासवम् आदराद् अविरतं रसयेयम् अहं न चेत्

kṣaṇam apīha na tāvakadāsatāṃ prati bhaveyam ahaṃ kila bhājanam / bhavadabhedarasāsavam ādarād avirataṃ rasayeyam ahaṃ na cet

let me not spend one moment here as anything
other than your servant's vessel — one who reverently,
unceasingly drinks the rasa-wine of your non-difference.[2]

The Wine of Non-Difference

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 4.18 · 4.18

Devotion as intoxication: the wine is non-duality itself.

WHAT IS IT

Abheda-rasāsava — the wine of non-difference. Śṛṅgāra's whole lexicon (wine, tasting, the beloved's feet) is applied to the doctrine: the beloved is not other, and the intoxication is the insight. The sthāyin rati becomes the taste of the one, and the servant becomes the vessel that holds it.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When you crave closeness to something: say it and re-cast — the wine is already poured (non-difference); you are the cup.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the difference stops registering as distance mid-verse — the room reads as already mixed, two wines that cannot be un-poured.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

warmth as if from a sip; the distance you wanted to close was the fiction.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 4.18

What Delight, Beloved

अम्बुदैः शिखिगणो विनाद्यते का रतिः प्रिय मया विनाद्य ते

ambudaiḥ śikhigaṇo vinādyate kā ratiḥ priya mayā vinādya te

by clouds the peacock-flock is sounded —
what delight, beloved, without me today?

What Delight, Beloved

KṢEMARĀJA, GHATAKARPARA (POT-SHERDS) V.5 · GHAT-P01 V5

Love-in-separation given to the whole landscape — the peacock's cry.

WHAT IS IT

Ghatakarpara, Kṣemarāja's night of the broken pot, frames longing as weather: the peacocks cry at cloud-arrival — and the cry is 'without me.' Vipralambha (longing-in-separation) is outsourced to the scene until the self-pity becomes a rainstorm that belongs to everyone. The ache is seasonal, not personal.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When longing for someone or something: say it as the peacock line — the cry is appropriate, beautiful, and will end with the rain. Feel the ache as weather: you are the bird, not the drowning.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

delight arrives with no cause you can name; you look for the trigger and find only him — the causelessness IS the answer.

Source: L4-ghat-p01-v05.DRAFT.json · ghat-p01 v5

The Moon That Carries the Nectar

प्रकाशां शीतलाम् एकां
शुद्धां शशिकलाम् इव /
दृशं वितर मे नाथ काम्
अप्य् अमृतवाहिनीम्

prakāśāṃ śītalām ekāṃ śuddhāṃ śaśikalām iva / dṛśaṃ vitara me nātha kām apy amṛtavāhinīm

give me one glance of yours — light, cool, pure,
like the moon's crescent, carrying nectar —
o lord, for my desire itself.

The Moon That Carries the Nectar

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 3.5 · 3.5

The cool moon-glance that carries desire instead of burning it.

WHAT IS IT

Kāma (desire) is not banned here but delivered amṛta: the verse asks for a dṛś, a gaze that is śītalā (cool) like the moon's crescent and amṛta-vāhinī (nectar-bearing). The erotic voltage of rati is converted into moonlight — desire needs cooling and nourishment, not cutting.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When desire runs hot: one breath in, offer the heat upward as the thing that needs the glance, and picture the crescent-cool gaze landing on it. The prayer cools by image, not by prohibition.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

cool nectar at the palate during recitation, and his absence reads as fullness rather than the other way round.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the heat stays but stops being an emergency.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 3.5





I I

Hāsya

the Comic — mirth & laughter

hāsya — "laughable, comic; mockery — that which slays" (from hās, to slay)

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sthāyin: hāsa — the world-as-joke; laughter is the register of the play seen from inside

Laughing, Dancing, Eating It All

हस्यते नृत्यते यत्र रागद्वेषादि भुज्यते / पीयते भक्तिपीयूषरसस् तत् प्राप्नुयां पदम्

hasyate nṛtyate yatra rāgadveṣādi bhujyate / pīyate bhaktipīyūṣarasas tat prāpnuyāṃ padam

where he laughs and dances, where desire and hatred themselves are eaten,
where the nectar-rasa of devotion is drunk —
may i attain that state.

Laughing, Dancing, Eating It All

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 5.18 · 5.18

The state where he laughs, dances, and eats the klesas for lunch.

WHAT IS IT

Hāsa's sthāyin hāsa is made cosmic: the divine one laughs and dances, and — the key verb — rāga-dveṣe bhujyate, desire and hatred are CONSUMED as food. Mirth here is not humour; it is the sound of digestion. The negative emotions are not banished from the state; they are the meal.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it when something finally stops being infuriating — and notice the laugh that arrives is the verse working.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the day's trouble provokes a laugh BEFORE the argument does — you catch yourself chuckling at what used to enrage.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the annoyance is suddenly chewable; that is bhujyate happening. Let the laugh be the proof.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 5.18

The Essence of Laughter

उपहासैकसारे ऽस्मिन्न् एतावति जगत्त्रये / तुभ्यम् एवाद्वितीयाय नमो नित्यसुखासिने

upahāsaikasāre 'sminn etāvati jagattraye / tubhyam evādvitīyāya namo nityasukhāsine

in this three-world joke whose essence is laughter —
to you alone, the non-dual, the one seated in eternal joy:
namas.

The Essence of Laughter

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 2.18 · 2.18

Bowing to the Lord who sits on laughter itself.

WHAT IS IT

The universe is upahāsa-ekasāra — the essence of the cosmic joke — and the Lord is nitya-sukha-āsina, seated in eternal joy. Laughter is not irreverence but the metaphysical register of the world-as-play seen from inside. You bow TO the seated laughter rather than laughing at him: reverence and joke in one breath.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When life turns absurd: say it, and read the absurdity as his seat.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the laugh thins into a smile that outlasts the recitation — his laughter has no off-switch, so the residue is the proof.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

irreverence without disrespect — the sigh turns into a chuckle, and the chuckle lands on him.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 2.18

His Laughing-Play

जयन्ति ते जगद्वन्द्या दासास् ते जगतां विभो / संसारार्णव एवैष येषां क्रीडामहासरः

jayanti te jagadvandyā dāsās te jagatāṃ vibho / saṃsārārṇava evaiṣa yeṣāṃ krīḍāmahāsaraḥ

victorious are your servants, lord of the worlds —
for whom this ocean of saṃsāra
is a laughing-play.

His Laughing-Play

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 3.15 · 3.15

Same ocean as everyone else's; for his servants it's a playground.

WHAT IS IT

Everyone else drowns in saṃsārārṇava — the ocean of becoming. For yeṣāṃ (for those servants) it is krīḍā-hāsara: a park of laughter and play. Hāsa changes the ownership of the ocean, not its water. The rasa-shift happens before the circumstance shifts — the ocean is the fact, the playground is the flavour.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In a hard moment, name it: ocean. Then say the verse, and the water becomes shallow.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the play becomes visible: chore, traffic, inbox read as stage business mid-shift — you are amused because he is amused.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the shoulders drop and the mouth lifts before the situation changes at all.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 3.15

Angry, Then Laughing, Then Śiva

भक्तिक्षीवो ऽपि कुप्येयं भवायानुशयीय च / तथा हसेयं उद्यां च रटेयं च शिवेत्य् अलम्

bhaktikṣīvo 'pi kupyeyaṃ bhavāyānuśayīya ca / tathā haseyaṃ udyāṃ ca raṭeyaṃ ca śivety alam

let me be drunk on devotion — and angry with the world,
and pitying it — then laugh, and rise up, and shout:
śiva! — enough.

Angry, Then Laughing, Then Śiva

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.7 · 16.7

The permission slip: devotion lets you rage, then laugh, then shout.

WHAT IS IT

The verse gives the full emotional sequence and blesses every step: bhakti-kṣīva (drunk on devotion) → kupyeyam (let me be angry!) → haseyaṃ (then laugh) → udyām (rise) → raṭeyam śivety (shout Śiva). Anger is not the failure of the practice but its middle passage — it converts to laughter to shout. Hāsa is the hinge where the negative becomes praise.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When worked up: say it as an instruction manual — drunk first, then let it become laugh, rise, and shout. The last word must be Śiva, out loud if you dare.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the anger expires mid-flare: heat turns to laughter in seconds, and Śiva is what is left of it.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the anger doesn't get suppressed; it gets promoted.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.7





III

Karuṇā

the Pathetic — grief & compassion

karuṇā — "compassion, mercy; the pitiable, what moves to pity"

---

sthāyin: śoka — "all rasas are essentially pleasurable, even the painful" — grief is bliss in a minor key (Abhinavabhāratī)

The Seed of Sorrow

चित्रं निसर्गतो नाथ
दुःखबीजम् इदं मनः /
त्वद्भक्तिरससंसिक्तम्
निःश्रेयसमहाफलम्

citraṃ nisargato nātha duḥkhabījam idaṃ manaḥ / tvadbhaktirasasaṃsiktam
niḥśreyasamahāphalam

strange, lord: this mind is by nature the seed of sorrow —
yet watered with the rasa of your devotion
it ripens into the highest fruit.

The Seed of Sorrow

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.26 · 1.26

The sorrow-seed that ripens instead of rotting.

WHAT IS IT

The verse concedes the grief outright: manaḥ is duḥkha-bīja by nature (nisargataḥ) — the mind was born a grief-seed. The surprise (citra!) is the alchemy: watered with bhakti-rasa it becomes niḥśreyasa-mahāphala, the highest fruit. Karuṇā is not healed by removal but by irrigation — the same seed, different harvest.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In grief: say it and water the seed instead of cursing the soil.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the sorrow warms instead of hardening — tears come carrying the seed; grief tenderised, not numbed.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the grief stays, but it is being used; even the tears count as irrigation.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.26

The Flood Over Joy and Sorrow

हर्षाणाम् अथ शोकानां सर्वेषां प्लावकः समम् / भवद्ध्यानामृतापूरो निम्नाणिम्नभुवाम् इव

harṣāṇām atha śokānāṃ sarveṣāṃ plāvakaḥ samam / bhavaddhyānāmṛtāpūro nimnāṇimnabhuvām iva

the flood of nectar from meditating you overflows
joy and sorrow alike — like waters filling
all the low and lower lands.

The Flood Over Joy and Sorrow

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 3.9 · 3.9

One flood levels the hierarchy of gladness and grief.

WHAT IS IT

A single amṛta-pūra (flood of nectar from dhyāna) covers harṣa AND śoka samam — equally, like water filling every lowland. Sorrow gets no special treatment and no special exclusion: both emotions are terrain, and the flood is the same. Karuṇā's transformation is levelling, not fixing.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it in either state — grief or glee — the verse works on the level of the field, not the feeling.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the same tide runs under joy and grief: a wave of tenderness crosses either one, indifferent to the day's weather.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

a settling, as if water found its level; the ranking of emotions collapses.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 3.9

Sorrow Mixed with Ghee

देव दुःखान्य् अशेषाणि यानि संसारिणाम् अपि /
घृत्याख्यभवदीयात्मयुतान्य्
आयान्ति सह्यताम्

deva duḥkhāny aśeṣāṇi yāni saṃsāriṇām api /
ghṛtyākhyabhavadīyātmayutāny āyānti sahyatām

lord, the countless sorrows even of the world-dweller —
mixed with your own self they become ghee:
they come to be bearable.
11

Sorrow Mixed with Ghee

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 10.16 · 10.16

Sorrow mixed with Śiva-self becomes ghee — and ghee is bearable.

WHAT IS IT

The alchemical verse: duḥkha + bhavat-īya-ātman (your own self) = ghṛta (ghee). Ghee does not remove the ingredient — it transforms its texture: the sharp is suspended in the smooth. The grief survives as substance but not as edge. Karuṇā's medicine is texture change, not argument.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In pain: say the ghee line and literally imagine the sharp edge of the feeling being coated.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

ghee in the fire: the pain stays hot but stops burning — clarified, and the grief tastes somehow sweet.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the body responds to texture, not to reasons — the tightness loosens because the sharpness is now suspended.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 10.16

The Banner Against Suffering

हे नाथ प्रणतार्तिनाशनपटो श्रेयोनिधे धूर्जटे
दुःखैकायतनस्य जन्ममरणत्रस्तस्य मे साम्प्रतम् /
तच् चेष्टस्व यथा मनोज्ञविषयास्वादप्रदा उत्तमा
जीवन्न् एव समश्नुवे ऽहम् अचलाः सिद्धीस्
त्वदर्चापरः

he nātha praṇatārtināśanapaṭo śreyonidhe dhūrjaṭe duḥkhaikāyatanasya janmamaraṇatrastasya me sāmpratam / tac ceṣṭasva yathā manojñaviṣayāsvādapradā uttamā jīvann eva samaśnuve 'ham acalāḥ siddhīs tvadarcāparaḥ

o lord, the banner that destroys the suffering of the bowing —
treasure of good, dhūrjaṭa: for me whose only home is sorrow,
afraid of birth and death — so act for me, that while yet living
i may enjoy the sweet taste of the good sense-objects,
unshakeable, the powers in service of your worship.

The Banner Against Suffering

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 11.14 · 11.14

The emergency prayer: grief addressed to the Destroyer-of-pain by name.

WHAT IS IT

The Lord is named by function: praṇatārti-nāśana-paṭa — the flag that annihilates the pain of the one who bows. The verse locates the speaker without self-pity: ālaya-eka — sorrow is the only house I know, and I fear birth and death. The grief is fully stated before the name is invoked — confession first, then the banner.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

At 3am in the pit: say the whole confession first, then the name.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the suffering, looked at with him, converts — the resistance drops and what remains is clean sorrow, which moves.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the banner is real — a flag planted IN the grief, not flying over it. The fear of birth and death can be said out loud; that's the verse's permission.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 11.14





I V

Raudra

the Furious — anger & rage

raudra — "furious, stormy — the mood of Rudra" (rudra: to roar)

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sthāyin: krodha — anger exists because it is one with the wonder that is the experience of consciousness (Tantrāloka 15254)

The Axe of 'All Is His'

एतन् मम न त्व् इदम् इति रागद्वेषादिनिगडदृढमूले / नाथ भवन्मयतैक्यप्रत्ययपरशुः पतत्वन्तः

etan mama na tv idam iti rāgadveṣādinigaḍadṛḍhamūle / nātha bhavanmayataikyapratyayaparaśuḥ patatvantaḥ

'this is mine, this is not yours' — the roots of attachment and aversion, hard-shackled;
o lord, let the axe of the one conviction 'all is your-become' fall on them in me.

The Axe of 'All Is His'

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 7.2 · 7.2

The engine of rage is mine-ness; the axe is the conviction that all is his.

WHAT IS IT

Anger's roots are rāga-dveṣa driven by mamaka (mine-ness) — 'etan mama, na tv idam' (this is mine, this is not yours). The remedy named is an instrument: paraśu, the axe of ekatva-pratyaya — the conviction that everything is bhavanmaya, his-become. The verse PRAYS FOR THE AXE TO FALL — an act, not a mood.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In rage: name the possession first — 'mine', 'not yours' — then say the verse at it.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the anger gets an address instead of a target: heat stays, aim dissolves — the fist unclenching mid-sentence.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the fist unclenches not by relaxing but by losing the ownership record; the thing remains, the claiming ends.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 7.2

Let the Anger Ripen

मानावमानरागादिनिष्पाकविमलं मनः / यस्यासौ भक्तिमांल् लोकतुल्यशीलः कथं भवेत्

mānāvamānarāgādiniṣpākavimalaṃ manaḥ / yasyāsau bhaktimāṃl lokatulyaśīlaḥ kathaṃ bhavet

the mind purified by the complete ripening of
honour and dishonour, rāga and the rest —
such a devotee: how could he have ordinary-world conduct?

Let the Anger Ripen

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.15 · 16.15

Pride, slight and rage treated as things that must fully ripen first.

WHAT IS IT

Māna, avamāna (honour and dishonour), rāga — these must NIṢPĀKA, ripen completely, like poison cooked out or fruit brought to sweetness. The purified mind is the one where the indignation-mix has finished its fermentation. The verse reframes the anger-process itself: give it heat and time, and the result is clarity instead of explosion.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When slighted: say it and let the feeling ripen rather than react — the insult is being cooked, not served.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the anger ripens without a victim — it swells, sweetens, and passes THROUGH you rather than at anyone.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the heat continues but stops being an instruction to act.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.15

Devotion Conquers the Darkness

रागद्वेषन्धकारो ऽपि येषां भक्तित्विषा जितः / तेषां महीयसाम् अग्रे कतमे ज्ञानशालिनः

rāgadveṣandhakāro 'pi yeṣāṃ bhaktitviṣā jitaḥ / teṣāṃ mahīyasām agre katame jñānaśālinaḥ

in whose case even the darkness of attachment and aversion
has been conquered by the brilliance of devotion —
what to speak of the learned, among such exalted ones?

Devotion Conquers the Darkness

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.16 · 16.16

Rage is a lightless state; devotion is the light that ends it.

WHAT IS IT

Rāga-dveṣa are andhakāra — darkness; bhakti-tviṣ, the brilliance of devotion, is the conqueror. The verse gives light-physics to anger: not fight the dark, but shine. And what remains after conquest is not the repressed but mahīyas — the exalted, lit-up ones. The learned don't even rate in comparison.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it as a light-switch claim: the anger is dark, and you are switching on devotion rather than wrestling the dark.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the darkness shrinks when named with devotion: the rage feels borrowed and slightly comic, a costume someone else chose.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

warmth precedes relief — that order is the physics.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.16

Your Wrath Purifies

वन्द्यास् ते ऽपि महीयांसः प्रलयोपगता अपि / त्वत्कोपपावकस्पर्शपूता ये परमेश्वर

vandyās te 'pi mahīyāṃsaḥ pralayopagatā api / tvatkopapāvakasparśapūtā ye parameśvara

also worthy of praise, O supreme, are those
made pure by the touch of your wrath's fire
even when you have destroyed them.

Your Wrath Purifies

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 10.20 · 10.20

Even his wrath is a purifier — so the fire itself is praised.

WHAT IS IT

Tvat-kopa-pāvaka — the fire of your wrath — is pāvaka, a purifier, by definition. Those touched (even annihilated) by it are pūtā, purified. Raudra's rasa seen from the other side: divine anger is cauterisation, not punishment. The devotee's praise of THAT is the final surrender of the complaint against anger itself.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When caught in a rage — yours or someone's's: say it, and re-classify the fire as purifying touch before responding.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the purifying heat runs hot then cools clean — like lye burning off grime: emptied, not inflamed.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the flinch converts to a bow.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 10.20





V

Vīra

the Heroic — valour & energy

vīra — "heroic, manly valour; mighty effort"

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sthāyin: utsāha — enthusiasm is the energy of recognition, not of the task

Victory — the World Depends on Him

जय देव नमो नमो ऽस्तु ते
सकलं विश्वम् इदं तवाश्रितम्
/ जगतां परमेश्वरो भवान्
परमेकः शरणागतो ऽस्मि ते

jaya deva namo namo 'stu te sakalaṃ viśvam idaṃ tavāśritam / jagatāṃ parameśvaro bhavān paramekaḥ śaraṇāgato 'smi te

victory, lord — namas, namas to you:
this entire universe depends on you;
you are the supreme lord of the worlds, the one —
in you alone i take refuge.

Victory — the World Depends on Him

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 2.29 · 2.29

The victory-cry that puts the whole world on his back.

WHAT IS IT

Vīra's sthāyin utsāha begins with jaya — twice — then the cosmic dependency: sakalaṃ viśvam idaṃ tavāśritam, everything rests on YOU. The hero's strength is deliberately outsourced: your energy becomes his vehicle rather than your own inventory. Enthusiasm as alignment, not as ego.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Morning, before the task: say it once under the breath, fast.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the world's weight becomes a load you carry FOR him — the shoulders read as strong because the load is his.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the chest widens; effort turns from strain into celebration because the weight is his, not yours.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 2.29

May I Become the Grass

अन्तर्भक्तिचमत्कारचर्वणामीलितेक्षणः / नमो मह्यं शिवायेति पूजयम् स्यां तृणान्य् अपि

antarbhakticamatkāracarvaṇāmīlitekṣaṇaḥ / namo mahyaṃ śivāyeti pūjayam syāṃ tṛṇāny api

when, eyes closed in the tasting of inner devotion-wonder,
i worship 'namas to śiva' —
may i become even the grass [in that place].

May I Become the Grass

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 5.15 · 5.15

So lost in devotion's wonder one would be the grass at the threshold.

WHAT IS IT

The extreme of vīra-bhakti: antar-bhakti-catkāra (inner wonder) savoured until the eyes close (āmīlitekṣaṇa), and the self-offer is to become tṛṇa — grass, trodden, at his doorway. Heroism here is the heroism of disappearance INTO devotion; the glory is to be the least impressive thing present.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When enthusiasm needs depth rather than noise: say it and offer to be the least impressive thing in the room.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

self-importance flattens into willingness: you would be grass — usable, trodden without injury — and the humiliation-feel never arrives.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the wanting-to-be-seen dissolves; the energy continues without the vanity.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 5.15

The Sound That Never Leaves the Mouth

ते जयन्ति मुखमण्डले भ्रमन्
अस्ति येषु नियतं शिवध्वनिः /
यः शाशीव प्रसृतो ऽमृताशयात्
स्वादु संस्रवति चामृतं परम्

te jayanti mukhamaṇḍale bhraman asti yeṣu niyataṃ śivadhvaniḥ / yaḥ śāśīva prasṛto 'mṛtāśayāt svādu saṃsravati cāmṛtaṃ param

victorious those on whose mouth's circle
the sound of śiva constantly roams —
ever-streaming from the immortal reservoir,
the supreme nectar dripping sweet.

The Sound That Never Leaves the Mouth

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 4.14 · 4.14

Victory to the constant chanter — japa become involuntary.

WHAT IS IT

Niyataṃ śivadhvaniḥ — the Śiva-sound circulating the face without stop (the gloss: twenty-four hours). Vīra's utsāha here is constancy: practice that has become self-running — the ajapa that the Vijñāna Bhairava describes as breath itself. The verse is a toast to the one whose mantra no longer needs permission.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it when you catch the name rising on its own — mid-shower, mid-walk. The verse applauds the practice applauding itself.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the mantra becomes non-negotiable: audible in the chest at odd hours, unsummoned, running like a pulse.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

pride WITH devotion; the discipline patting itself on the back.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 4.14

Praised Because You Worship

चपलम् असि यद् अपि मानस
तत्रापि श्लाघ्यसे यतो भजसे /
शरणानाम् अपि शरणं
त्रिभुवनगुरुम् अम्बिकाकान्तम्

capalam asi yad api mānasa tatrāpi ślāghyase yato bhajase / śaraṇānām api śaraṇaṃ tribhuvanagurum ambikākāntam

o mind, though you are flickering, yet you are praised —
because you worship:
you take refuge in the refuge of the refuges,
the teacher of the three worlds, the beloved of ambikā.

Praised Because You Worship

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 4.1 · 4.1

The distracted mind is praised for showing up anyway.

WHAT IS IT

Capala (flickering, unstable) is normally the enemy of every practice — the verse reverses the verdict: slāghyase, you are PRAISED, yato bhajase, because you worship. Utsāha for the distracted: the measure is not steadiness but direction. Even a scattering mind in the direction of refuge earns the praise.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Address it TO your mind, in the second person, when it won't hold — praise it for showing up rather than scolding it for drifting.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

being praised while you worship feels like being read out loud by him — and the need for more of it stops.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

self-compassion as fuel; the scattered mind sits down when praised, not when punished.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 4.1





V I

Bhayānaka

the Horrible — fear & anxiety

bhayānaka — "causing fear: terrible, dreadful" (bhaya: fear)

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sthāyin: bhaya — fear is real even when its object is a rope; use the realness, skip the object (Abhinavabhāratī, rope-snake)

When Will I Suddenly Recognise You

ईश्वरम् अभयम् उदारं पूर्णम् अकारणम् अपह्नुतात्मानं / सहसाभिज्ञाय कदा स्वामिजनं लज्जयिष्यामि

īśvaram abhayam udāraṃ pūrṇam akāraṇam apahnutātmānaṃ /
sahasābhijñāya kadā svāmijanaṃ lajjayiṣyāmi

the lord — fearless, generous, full, causeless,
beyond denial of self — when will i suddenly recognise him —
and put the master's own folk to shame?

When Will I Suddenly Recognise You

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 9.6 · 9.6

Addressed to the Lord whose very name is fearlessness.

WHAT IS IT

Bhayānaka's sthāyin bhaya meets Īśvara who is abhaya — fearless — and the cure named is sahasābhijñā, sudden recognition, not calm. The verse's logic: fear is the pre-recognition static, and kadā — when — is a countdown to the flash. Recognising him puts the world (which produced the fear) to shame.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When fear is up: say it as a question, not a plea — kadā? when?.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

a small fright turns into the jump OF recognition — fear and ambush become the same doorway.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

fear becomes the sound before the recognition rather than the enemy of it. After the last word, expect nothing; the asking is the turning.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 9.6

The Full Confession

मूढो ऽस्मि दुःखकलितो ऽस्मि जरादिदोषभीतो ऽस्मि शक्तिरहितो ऽस्मि तवाश्रितो ऽस्मि / शम्भो तथा कलय शीघ्रम् उपैमि येन सर्वोत्तमां धुरम् अपोज्झितदुःखमार्गः

mūḍho 'smi duḥkhakalito 'smi jarādidoṣabhīto 'smi śaktirahito 'smi tavāśrito 'smi / śambho tathā kalaya śīghram upaimi yena sarvottamāṃ dhuram apojjhitaduḥkhamārgaḥ

i am dull, i am weighed with sorrow, i am afraid of old age's flaws,
i am without power — i have taken refuge in you, o śambhu;
so calculate what's left.

The Full Confession

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 11.8 · 11.8

The full inventory — including the fear of decay — ending in refuge.

WHAT IS IT

The verse itemises the negative self-image without flinching: mūḍha (dull), duḥkhakṛta (sorrow-woven), jarā-doṣa-bhīta (afraid of old age's flaws), śakti-hīna (powerless) — and then the pivot: tavāśritaḥ asmi, I have taken refuge. Named fears lose volume; the inventory ends in a single act of leaning.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

List YOUR four in his cadence, then land the last line.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the worst you can say about yourself is out loud and addressed; the dread it carried does not follow it out.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the inventory leaves the body lighter; the refuge-line is the exhale. Especially for aging-anxiety and inadequacy-shame.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 11.8

The Aghora Mantra

अघोरेभ्यो ऽथ घोरेभ्यो घोरघोरतरीभ्यश्च । सर्वतः शर्व सर्वेभ्यो नमस्ते रुद्ररूपेभ्यः ॥

aghorebhyo 'tha ghorebhyo ghoraghoratarībhyaśca | sarvataḥ śarva sarvebhyo namaste rudrarūpebhyaḥ ||

salutations to aghora, to ghora, to ghoraghora-tarī — to sarva in all directions, to all the rudra-forms: namas.

The Aghora Mantra

YAJURVEDA · CHANTED BY SWAMI LAKSHMANJOO AT EVERY WEEKLY SANGHA · SECRET SUPREME CH.13 · LETTER 1989

The Sangha's opening chant. Swamiji's directive after his 1989 vision: spread this message all over the world.

WHAT IS IT

The verse salutes the three energies of Rudra as his forms. Per Swamiji's Tantrāloka 3.257-259 teaching: Aghorā carries you to God-consciousness at once, even without your wish (cit-śakti); Ghorā makes the desirer wait — 'don't hurry, just we will see the time' (icchā-śakti); Ghoratarī carries the careless downward (jñāna-śakti). The protection invoked is real but conditional: Svacchandanātha's eighteen arms are the eighteen tattvas, outgrowths of the five śaktis, made for the protection of the individual — but protection requires the yamas and niyamas, the supreme of which is īśvara-praṇidhāna: if you love Lord Śiva and are devoted to Him, it is not possible for Him to neglect you.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Chant it where Swamiji put it: at the opening of any practice — this is the beginning of the Weekly Sangha. Three to nine rounds, aloud. When to: first thing in the morning, or at any moment of fear — you are addressing the three energies directly. Effect, per the tradition he taught: protection through the eighteen arms and purification of the three channels, body, speech and mind. His own instruction for its spread: 'You should spread this message all over the world.'

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the flinch arrives half a second late or not at all: what repulsed you now reads as his body in another mood.

Source: efficacy-aghora.pdf · Secret Supreme ch.13 · letter 1989

The Scorching Dissolved

लब्धाणिमादिसिद्धिर्
विगलितसकलोपतापसन्त्रासः
/
त्वद्भक्तिरसायनपानक्रिढानिष्टः
कदासीय

labdhāṇimādisiddhir vigalitasakalopatāpasantrāsaḥ /
tvadbhaktirasāyanapānakriḍhāniṣṭaḥ kadāsīya

when will i come to dwell in the drinking-and-playing
of your devotion-nectar — with the eight powers attained,
and all fear of troubles dissolved?

The Scorching Dissolved

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 9.18 · 9.18

Anticipatory dread melts in the rasa-cup.

WHAT IS IT

Two claims: the eight siddhis may be attained (the vīra-bait), but the real payload is vigalita-upātāpa-santrāsa — the dread-of-burn having MELTED in the rāsa-drinking. Upātāpa is the scorching anxiety of what's coming; it isn't fought, it is dissolved in the cup. Fear as something you drink through.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Anxious about what's coming? Take the verse as a drink-description and sip your current state as rasa.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the scorch dissolves into warmth: the heat reverses mid-verse — what scorched now only warms.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the anticipatory heat cools; the future stops glowing red.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 9.18





VII

Bībhatsa

the Disgusting — disgust & self-loathing

bībhatsa — "loathsome, revolting; that which excites disgust"

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sthāyin: jugupsā — disgust points at the un-looked-at; the cure is darśana, seeing

The Smear That Is Forgetting

अन्तर् अप्य् अतितराम्
अणीयसी या
त्वदप्रथनकालिकास्ति मे /
ताम् अपीश परिमृज्य सर्वतः
स्वं स्वरूपम् अमलं प्रकाशय

antar apy atitarām aṇīyasī yā tvadaprathanakālikāsti me / tām apīśa parimṛjya sarvataḥ svaṃ svarūpam amalaṃ prakāśaya

even within, the tiniest smear that is my non-contemplation of you —
wiping that, o lord, from everywhere,
[show] your own form.

The Smear That Is Forgetting

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 13.2 · 13.2

The impurity isn't filth; it's the lapse of remembering.

WHAT IS IT

The mala is tvad-apratana-kālikā — even the moment's failure to think of him. Bībhatsa's disgust, redirected: the thing that disgusts is not dirt but forgetting. And the wiping (parimṛjya) reveals svarūpa — the cleaner the frame, the more the face shows. Disgust at the stain becomes longing for what the stain hid.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In self-loathing: rename the stain — it is just the lapse of attention. Wipe = return, not scrub.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the smear reads as forgetting, not filth — self-disgust softens mid-name: it is the smudge, not the mirror.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the self-hatred loses its subject, and what's left is a fresh look at his form.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 13.2

The Impure Mind, Confessed

मनसि मलिने मदीयेमग्ना
त्वद्भक्तिमणिलता कष्टम् / न
निजान् अपि तनुते
तानपौरुषेयान्
स्वसम्पदुल्लासान्

manasi maline madīyemagnā tvadbhaktimaṇilatā kaṣṭam / na nijān api tanute tānapauruṣeyān svasampadullāsān

in my mind, absolutely impure, my own devotion-vine drowned
—
hard: it ripens not even its own,
the unearned blossoms of its fortune.

The Impure Mind, Confessed

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 15.14 · 15.14

The raw confession — the devotion-vine drowned in muck.

WHAT IS IT

Bībhatsa at its least polite: maline manasi, the mind is dirty, and the bhakti-latā (devotion-vine) is submerged under it — so even its own virtues don't ripen. Utpaladeva includes the complaint in the hymn-book itself: self-disgust, spoken, IS bhakti's material. The shame is not edited out; it is a verse.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it on the days you feel worst about yourself — the hymn says it for you, better.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the inventory of impurity is spoken almost fondly — aversion drains when it is finally reported.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

honesty displaces shame; the muck, spoken aloud, is at least seen.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 15.14

The Doubt-Enemy Shattered

खरनिषेधखदामृतपूरणोच्छलितधौतविकल्पमलस्य मे /
दलितदुर्जयसंशयवैरिणस्
त्वदवलोकनम् अस्तु निरन्तरम्

kharaniṣedhakhadāmṛtapūraṇocchalitadhautavikalpamalasya me /
dalitadurjayasaṃśayavairiṇas tvadavalokanam astu nirantaram

the thought-stain in my mind, scoured by the deathless nectar's flood
poured over the trough of refuse — with the invincible doubt-enemy crushed:
let beholding you be unceasing.

The Doubt-Enemy Shattered

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 18.19 · 18.19

The stain's partner in crime is doubt — and seeing breaks both.

WHAT IS IT

The verse names the double-bind: mala (the mind's stain) and the durjaya saṃśaya-vairin (the invincible doubt-enemy). Both are destroyed by ONE thing: tvad-avalokana-janita-phala — the fruit born of beholding him. Disgust's cure is not more scrubbing but darśana, the look. The enemy of clarity was never dirt; it was the un-looked-at.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When the mind feels stained AND doubting: stop scrubbing, start looking — one look inward at the form.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the doubt-enemy loses its repetition compulsion: the nagging question is heard once and does not come back.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

doubt and disgust fall together because they were both standing in the dark.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 18.19

Strike the Dividing-Piece

विलीने शङ्कौघे सपदि
परिपूर्णे च विभवे ।
संहाराख्या मम हृदि
भिदांशं प्रहरतु

vilīne śaṅkaughe sapadi paripūrṇe ca vibhave | saṃhārākhyā mama hṛdi bhidāṃśaṃ praharatu

in the melted doubt-heap, at once in full glory —
o lord named dissolution, strike the split portion of my heart.

Strike the Dividing-Piece

ABHINAVAGUPTA, KRAMASTOTRA 19.19 · KRAM-P19 V19

The hunger that keeps cutting — finished when doubt melts.

WHAT IS IT

Kramastotra's verse from Abhinavagupta's own recitation-list: śaṅkaugha (the doubt-flood) is gone, pūrṇa (fullness) stands — and then ONE request: strike the hṛdi-bhidāṃśa, the fragment that divides the heart. The disgust behind bībhatsa was the partition-making: the inner cutter that keeps fullness in two halves. Saṃhāra (dissolution) finishes the surgery.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

After weeks of inner division — this vs that, me vs it: say it as the surgeon's request, once.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the dividing-piece is struck: what disgusted you now shares your substance — aversion flips to inclusion.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the split seals; the hunger to divide ends with the knife that isn't yours.

Source: L4-kram-p19.DRAFT.json · kram-p19 v19





VIII

Adbhuta

the Marvellous — wonder & awe

adbhuta — "the un-become: astonishing, marvellous, unprecedented" (a-dbhūta)

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sthāyin: vismaya — wonder (camatkāra) is the primary characteristic of consciousness itself (Tantrāloka ad 1/53)

The Wonder of the Word at Tongue-Tip

शिव इत्य् एकशब्दस्य जिह्वाग्रे तिष्ठतः सदा / समस्तविषयास्वादो भक्तेष्व् एवास्ति को ऽप्य् अहो

śiva ity ekaśabdasya jihvāgre tiṣṭhataḥ sadā / samastaviṣayāsvādo bhakteṣv evāsti ko 'py aho

when the single word śiva stands ever at the tongue's tip —
the taste of all sense-objects exists in the devotee alone.
what a wonder!

The Wonder of the Word at Tongue-Tip

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.20 · 1.20

One word at tongue-tip transmutes every taste into rasa.

WHAT IS IT

The verse compresses Vijñāna: the mantra at the organ of taste (jihvāgra) transmutes all viṣaya-āsvāda — every sense-object is tasted as devotion. The aho! is technical: it is vismaya at the mechanism itself — wonder as the experience of the doctrine working. Adbhuta is testable in one bite.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When anything tastes or sounds flat: place Śiva at the tongue's tip and re-taste the next sip or bite.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the syllable you have said a hundred times reads as freshly minted — the word at tongue-tip works.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the wonder is measurable — if the flavour deepens, the verse is real.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.20

The Wonderful Deceiver

मायाविने विशुद्धाय गुह्याय प्रकटात्मने / सूक्ष्माय विश्वरूपाय नमश् चित्राय शम्भवे

māyāvine viśuddhāya guhyāya prakaṭātmane / sūkṣmāya viśvarūpāya namaś citrāya śambhave

namas to the deceptive, the pure, the secret,
the manifest-self, the subtle, the all-form —
to the citra, to śambhu.

The Wonderful Deceiver

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 2.12 · 2.12

Bowing to the wonderful one whose wonder IS his trick.

WHAT IS IT

Citra — variegated, marvellous, strange — is the epithet running through the verse, married to māyāvine (the deceiver), prakaṭātmane (the manifest secret). The universe's strangeness is his craft, not a malfunction. Adbhuta here is delight in the trick: the weirdness of the world is filed as artistry.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When the world turns surreal — say the verse and file the strangeness under citra.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the day's setup — the coincidence, the irony — shows as artistry: you are impressed instead of ambushed.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the uncanny flips from threat to artistry; the trick becomes someone's excellent work.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 2.12

The Wheel of Diverse States

य एष
विततस्फुरद्विविधभावचक्रात्मकः
परस्परविभेदवान्विषयतामुपागच्छति
यदेकमयभावनावशत एत्यभेदान्वयं स
शंभुरशिवापहो जयति बोधभासां
निधिः

ya eṣa vitatasphuradvividhabhāvacakrātmakaḥ
parasparavibhedavānviṣayatāmupāgacchati yadekamayabhāvanāvaśata
etyabhedānvayaṃ sa śaṃbhuraśivāpaho jayati bodhabhāsāṃ nidhiḥ

he who, made of the widely flashing wheel of diverse states, comes to be the objects of experience — whose one, given to contemplation, is the bond of non-difference: he, śaṃbhu, averter of woe, triumphs — treasury of the lights of knowing.

The Wheel of Diverse States

ABHINAVAGUPTA, GĪTĀRTHASAṄGRAHA V.1 · GITA-A00 V1

Abhinavagupta's own opening: the wheel of states resolves into one — triumph.

WHAT IS IT

The Gītārthasaṃgraha's first breath performs its thesis: the flash-wheel of manifold states (thoughts, emotions, the day's weather — the very stuff of experience) resolves into abheda, non-difference — and that resolution is jayati, triumph. Adbhuta as the wonder OF the doctrine: the many flashing states are not noise but the treasury-house (nidhi) of knowing-light.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Use it as the invocation before any prayer-session in this book: name the swirl of your current states as the wheel, then remember the wheel IS the treasury.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

you SEE the states change as they change — the rotation itself becomes the marvel, not its contents.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the chaos of feelings gets reclassified as treasure on sight.

Source: L4-gita-a00-v01.DRAFT.json · gita-a00 v1

Worship Without Begging

अहो भक्तिभरोदारचेतसां वरद त्वयि / स्लाघ्यः पूजाविधिः को ऽपि यो न याच्ञाकलंकितः

aho bhaktibharodāracetasāṃ varada tvayi / slāghyaḥ pūjāvidhiḥ ko 'pi yo na yācñākalaṃkitaḥ

wonder! o boon-giver: among the full-hearted in devotion
toward you,
is any mode of worship praised
that is not stained with begging?

Worship Without Begging

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.24 · 17.24

The great wonder: worship with no shopping list attached.

WHAT IS IT

Vismaya at the bhaktas whose pūjā carries no yācñā — no begging-stain. The worship without a price-tag is the marvel; the wonder is the devotee's purity of motive, not the display. Adbhuta turns inward: amazed at the possibility of asking for nothing.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Notice when you've prayed with a shopping list. Say this verse as the correction, then worship once with nothing attached.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the petition-impulse is simply absent: you finish having wanted nothing, and that absence is the wonder.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the ask drops and the song stays — that gap is the wonder.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.24





IX

Śānta

the Peaceful — Abhinavagupta's ninth

śānta — "pacified, allayed, put to rest" — the ninth, added by Abhinavagupta

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sthāyin: śānti — the ninth rasa, Abhinavagupta's own addition: the ocean in which the other eight swim

The Rasa Beyond the World

शान्तकल्लोलशीताच्छस्वादुभक्तिसुधाम्बुधौ / अलौकिकरसास्वादे सुस्थैः को ऽनाम गण्यते

śāntakallolaśītācchasvādubhaktisudhāmbudhau / alaukikarasāsvāde susthaiḥ ko 'nāma gaṇyate

diving in the ocean of devotion's nectar — with peaceful waves,
cool and white and sweet — tasting the alaukika rasa:
who among the steady even counts a name there?

The Rasa Beyond the World

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.21 · 1.21

Śānta's theory in one verse: the peaceful ocean, the non-worldly taste.

WHAT IS IT

Everything the Abhinavabhāratī says about rasa is here: śānta-kallola — the peace-wave ocean; svādubhakti-sudhāmbudhi — the nectar-ocean of sweet devotion; and alaukika-rasa-āsvāda — the BEYOND-WORLDLY tasting. Peace is not absence but the most extreme flavour, so intense that the steady (susthā) stop counting even names.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

For peace-practice: dive once, taste once, count nothing — not even the breath.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

nothing is being felt loudly, and the quiet itself has flavour — emotion settled into background hum.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the mental to-do list stops being readable; that illegibility is the alaukika flicker.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.21

All Time in the Worship-Union

भवत्पूजामयासङ्गसम्भो
गसुखिनो मम / प्रयातु
कालः सकलो ऽप्य्
अनन्तो ऽपीयदर्थये

bhavatpūjāmayāsaṅgasambhogasukhino mama / prayātu kālaḥ sakalo 'py ananto 'pīyadarthaye

may all my time — even the endless kind — pass
in the happiness of union with your worship;
that alone is what i crave.

All Time in the Worship-Union

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.12 · 17.12

The peaceful life defined: every hour inside the worship-union.

WHAT IS IT

Kāla (time) is the anxious substance — endless time is the dread of the future. The verse re-routes every hour into bhavat-pūjāmaya-saṅga-sukha, the happiness of joining-with-worship. Śānta as temporal peace: not a mood but a schedule filled with one activity. And the craving (īyadarthaye) is permitted — it is the only thirst worth keeping.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When the day stretches ahead daunting: pray the WHOLE day into the worship-frame, then do the next ordinary thing as its first item.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

recitation loses track of duration — you start at the kettle and end somewhere else: all-time-in-the-union.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the horizon softens; time becomes a room, not a corridor.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.12

For Peace, Not for Pleasure

शान्तये न सुखलिप्सुता मनाग्
भक्तिसम्भृतमदेषु तैः प्रभोः /
मोक्षमार्गणफलापि नार्थना
स्मर्यते हृदयहारिणः पुरः

śāntaye na sukhalipsutā manāg bhaktisambhṛtamadeṣu taiḥ prabhoḥ /
mokṣamārgaṇaphalāpi nārthanā smaryate hṛdayahāriṇaḥ puraḥ

for peace, not for pleasure-seeking — those intoxicated
with the fullness of your devotion, o lord;
even the fruit of searching for liberation they don't crave —
before you, the heart-stealer.

For Peace, Not for Pleasure

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 18.15 · 18.15

The anti-materialist verse: peace sought as peace, not as payoff.

WHAT IS IT

The devotee's intoxication aims at śāntaye — peace — na sukhalipsutā, explicitly NOT the pleasure-hunt; even mokṣa-phala (the fruit of liberation) is not craved. Śānta is the only desire that cancels desiring — and the verse says so without smugness: these ones don't even want the prize.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When peace turns into another acquisition-plan — this retreat, that technique, the next course — say it as the disarming.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

you want nothing from the recitation and it keeps going anyway — the not-for-pleasure test passes.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the goal releases you; the practice continues unburdened.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 18.15

Cries Like Bamboo-Drops

त्वत्कर्णदेशम धिशय्य महार्घभावम्
आक्रन्दितानि मम तुच्छतराणि यान्ति /
वंशान्तरालपतितानि
जलैकदेशखण्डानि मौक्तिकमणित्वम्
इवोद्वहन्ति

tvatkarṇadeśama dhiśayya mahārghabhāvam ākranditāni mama tucchatarāṇi yānti / vaṃśāntarālapatitāni jalaikadeśakhaṇḍāni mauktikamaṇitvam ivodvahanti

laying my cries at your ear's place, my dearest —
they grow small: like rain inside a bamboo-joint,
they rise as pearls.

Cries Like Bamboo-Drops

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 11.9 · 11.9

Even the cries get smaller when laid at his ear.

WHAT IS IT

The simile IS the practice: ākranda (cries) laid at his ear-shore become tucchatarāṇi — tinier — like rain slipping down inside a hollow bamboo. Śānta as acoustics: devotion is the volume knob. No silencing, no denial — just the difference between shouting into the void and speaking into an ear.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When crying or complaining: say it and consciously LAY the noise at his ear — the listener inside.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

tears with no grief attached — bamboo-drops: empty, cool, relieving; crying with no object is how śānta cries.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the sound gets smaller mid-sentence; the bamboo-joint is the quiet place behind your own listening.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 11.9

ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

TANTRIC PRAYER

COLOPHON

The prayers here are our own translations of the Sanskrit, checked line by line against the witnesses in our Kashmir Śaiva corpus (translation-work) — thirty-two from Utpaladeva's Śivastotrāvalī, plus Kṣemarāja's Ghatakarpara, Abhinavagupta's Kramastotra and Gītārthasaṅgraha. Each guide links its source file.

The rasa theory is Abhinavagupta's own — Abhinavabhāratī and Tantrāloka, quoted briefly and attributed; the references are flagged for verification against print editions. The three-layer naming follows Monier-Williams glosses and the conventional English rasa terms.

Swami Lakshmanjoo's material — the Aghora Mantra, its1989 letter, and the Śrī Bahurūpa-Garbha Stotra — is © the Hughes Family Trust, archived here and quoted briefly at his own instruction to "spread this message all over the world."

Set in Tiro Devanagari and Cormorant Garamond; A5; print-checked to the KDP paperback specification.

TANTRIC PRAYER · BUILT FROM TRANSLATION-WORK

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